Husain Haqqani, Pakistan's Ambassador to the US at the time this book was written, has suggested that by introducing foreigners from outside the region Pakistan was also seeking to replicate the Afghan experience in terms of generating international attention. A key component of Pakistan's strategy has been to internationalize the Kashmir conflict. Haqqani asserted that Pakistan's rulers hoped the image of foreign fighters coming to the aid of their fellow Muslims in Kashmir would have a similar international impact as it did during the Afghan war against the Soviets.[32] According to Haqqani, in addition to the public relations advantages, Pakistan assumed non-indigenous Kashmiris would be easier to control as well. The thinking was that because these militants lacked local support structures, they would be more reliant on the ISI and thus more pliable. Further, some of the initial 'guest mujahideen' were not Pakistani, but rather foreigners who had come for the Afghan jihad against the Soviets. A good number of them were not welcome in their home countries, meaning they had nowhere else to turn.[33]

In 1993 the Harkat-ul-Mujahideen and Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami, two Deobandi jihadi groups that had split from one another and were operating separately in Indian-administered Kashmir, reconciled to form Harkat-ul-Ansar [HuA]. The army and ISI directed more support to the newly formed group than to the other Pakistani proxies and, following the merger, HuA's militant activities greatly increased.[34] HuA initially served as the primary group through which 'guest mujahideen' fought in Kashmir. At first the foreign fighters' martial prowess won them the respect of the local populace. However, they were very abusive to the citizenry and soon their popularity was declining. Local support for the wider insurgency had already begun to wane by this time, and continued to slip over the next several years. By 1995 the insurgency had reached a stalemate and was entering a period of atrophy.[35] The army and ISI were looking to recapture the momentum, but HuA proved the wrong group for the job.

Control of its proxies was a very important factor for the ISI and with HuA it was lacking. To begin with, a number of HuA commanders in Indian-administered Kashmir exercised an uncomfortably high degree of autonomy from the group's leadership in Pakistan. This effectively meant that they enjoyed an uncomfortably high level of autonomy from their official handlers in the ISI, which also did not enjoy a satisfactory degree of leverage over the group as a whole. HuA drew a significant amount of its